

Peter James Aungle

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EDUCATION

Harvard University

PhD, Psychology

Dissertation: "Embodied models of health: mind-body unity and the psychological determinants of physical health"

Committee: Ellen Langer (primary advisor, committee chair), Leah Somerville, Fiery Cushman

Cambridge, MA

May 2026

University of California at Berkeley

BA, Psychology

Berkeley, CA

May 2009

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

oTree Open Source Research Foundation

Postdoctoral Research Fellow

June 2026 – May 2027

Harvard University, Department of Psychology

Postdoctoral Research Associate, Langer Lab

June 2026 – May 2027

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Research

Health psychology · Mind-body unity · Mindsets, attention, and expectations · Embodied models of health · Belief-based behavioral interventions

Teaching

Social psychology · Health psychology · Research methods · Positive psychology · Mentoring undergraduate researchers

PUBLICATIONS

Aungle, P., & Langer, E. (2023). Physical healing as a function of perceived time. *Scientific Reports*, 13(1), 22432. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-023-50009-3>

Aungle, P., & Langer, E. (2024). The borderline effect for diabetes: when no difference makes a difference. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 15. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2024.1333248>

Langer, E., & Aungle, P. (2024). How much do our thoughts shape our health? *Scientific American*. <https://www.scientificamerican.com/article/how-much-do-our-thoughts-shape-our-health/>

Aungle, P., Holmes, N., & Chen, D. (2026). Beyond Statistical Myopia: Replying to a Misguided Critique of Mind-Body Research. *Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science*. <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/pdf/10.1177/25152459261417257>

Aungle, P. & Langer, E. (under review). Embodied models of health: A theoretical framework of mind-body unity. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/ubtxw_v2 [Perspectives on Psychological Science]

Aungle, P. & Pagnini, F. (under review). Reconsidering the Exclusion of Langerian Mindfulness: A Commentary on Chems-Maarif et al. (2025). [Mindfulness]

Aungle, P., Matta, PM., Loecher, M., Chen, D. (*under review*). A computational framework of mind-body unity: formalizing embodied models of health. https://osf.io/preprints/psyarxiv/uq934_v1 [*Psychological Review*]

Aungle, P., Bross, J., Nagarathinam, V., Chen, D., & Langer, E. (*under review*). Manipulating temporal expectations to accelerate healing after cataract surgery: a randomized controlled trial. [*Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*]

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Sapers, N., Aungle, P., Langer, E. (*in prep*). From competencies to enactment: situational construal as a mechanism of transfer in social and emotional learning.

Aungle, P., Zhang, Y., Nagarathinam, V., Paradis, J., Chen, D. (*in prep*). The surprising power of sadness in workplace conflict: when vulnerability outperforms dominance.

Mehmood, S., Bakhtawar, A., Aungle, P., Brown, H., Reinhart, E., Chen, D. (*in prep*). Trickle-down wellness: the effects of mental health support for teachers on student stress and achievement.

Mehmood, S., Bakhtawar, A., Brown, H., Aungle, P., Reinhart, E., Chen, D. (*in prep*). Wearing the cure: public signaling in psychiatric care.

Aydinian, T., Barzilai, D., Aungle, P., Langer, E. (*in prep*). Mindfulness, mind-body unity, and longevity.

PRESENTATIONS

Aungle, P., Bross, J., Nagarathinam, V., Chen, D., & Langer, E. (2026, September). Manipulating temporal expectations to accelerate healing after cataract surgery: A randomized controlled trial. Paper presented at the Advances with Field Experiments (AFE) Conference, Chicago, IL.

Aungle, P., Zhang, Y., Nagarathinam, V., Paradis, J., & Chen, D. (2026, August). The surprising power of sadness in workplace conflict: When vulnerability outperforms dominance. Paper presented at the Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.

Aungle, P. (2023, April). Expectations and health: Thinking in terms of mind-body unity. Invited talk, Social Psychology Lunch Talk Series, Department of Psychology, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA.

Aungle, P. (2022, September). Perceived time and wound healing. Second-year project talk presented to the Department of Psychology, Harvard University, Cambridge, MA.

HONORS, AWARDS, AND GRANTS

2026 – 2027 Postdoctoral Research Fellowship, oTree Open Source Research Foundation (\$70,000)

2023 – 2026 Certificate of Distinction in Teaching, Harvard University (five semesters: Spring 2023, Fall 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2025, Spring 2026)

2024 – 2025 Dissertation Completion Fellowship, Harvard Griffin Graduate School of Arts and Sciences

2023 – 2024 Departmental Pedagogy Fellow, Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning, Harvard University

2024 Graduate Research Grant, Restricted Funds Committee, Harvard Department of Psychology (\$7,500, maximum award)

2022 Graduate Research Grant, Restricted Funds Committee, Harvard Department of Psychology (\$5,000)

2019 Stimson Fund Research Award, Harvard Department of Psychology (\$1,000)

2019 – 2021 Harvard Griffin GSAS Graduate Fellowship (full stipend and tuition)

Grant Applications Under Review

2026 John Templeton Foundation, “Mind Body Economics” (with Daniel L. Chen), \$738,428, submitted July 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Ten semesters of teaching experience with an average rating of 4.6/5.0

Harvard University, Psychology Department

Sole Instructor

“Instructional Styles in Psychology” Fall 2023, Spring 2024 — designed and taught the required pedagogy course for incoming psychology teaching fellows. Average rating 4.5/5.0.

Head Teaching Fellow

“Health: A Positive Psychology Perspective” (Ellen Langer). Fall 2023, 2025, 2026 (scheduled) — co-designed the syllabus and section materials and taught all sections. Average rating 4.88/5.0.

Teaching Fellow

“Introduction to Social Psychology” (Fiery Cushman; Ashwini Ashokkumar) — Spring 2023, 2026. Average rating 4.67/5.0.

“The Emotional Mind” (Leah Somerville) — Spring 2024. Average rating 4.5/5.0.

“Health: A Positive Psychology Perspective” (Ellen Langer) — Fall 2021, 2022. Average rating 4.32/5.0.

“Introduction to Psychological Science” (Jason Mitchell) — Spring 2022. Average rating 4.38/5.0.

Pedagogy Fellow (2023–24)

Advised teaching fellows, attended weekly Derek Bok Center for Teaching and Learning workshops, and completed a capstone supporting future psychology pedagogy fellows.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Columbia University

Research Assistant

New York, NY

2018 – 2019

Advisor: Janet Metcalfe

Project: Learning from errors

- Created problem sets for study participants designed to maximize what students learn from errors while preparing for the New York State Math Regents exam

- Consulted on the experimental design, particularly in terms of how to explain common errors and relate to the correct problem-solving process

University of California at Berkeley

Berkeley, CA

Research Assistant

2006 – 2009

Advisor: Darlene Francis

Projects: The development of risk preferences in rat pups; the effects of rank in social hierarchies on behavior in a competitive task

- Ran a study testing whether prenatal stress affects risk-taking in rat pups; prenatally stressed pups took significantly more physically threatening risks than controls.
- Designed and ran a study testing whether within-group social rank predicts competitive performance, pairing unfamiliar rats matched on physical dominance cues but differing in rank; higher-ranked rats outperformed comparable peers, though not significantly.

University of California at Berkeley

Berkeley, CA

Research Assistant

2007 – 2008

Advisor: Jack Glaser

Project: Implicit motivation to control prejudice

- Ran participants for an experimental study examining the implicit motivation to control prejudice in a “Shooter Task”

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Private Tutor, Smarter Test Prep, 2011 – 2021

Independent Options Trader & Investment Analyst, 2014 – 2016

Sales Analyst, Aflac Insurance Company, 2010 – 2011

Business Development Services Analyst, Goldman Sachs Asset Management, 2009 – 2010

Communications Analyst, Hattaway Communications, 2008 – 2009

Press Advance Lead, National Advance Team, Hillary Clinton for President, 2007 – 2008

REFERENCES

Ellen J. Langer, Ph.D.

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Leah H. Somerville, Ph.D.

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Daniel L. Chen, J.D., Ph.D.

Professor of Economics
CASBS Fellow, Stanford
University, 2026–2027
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